

Calling your regional center: a script

Your first call to the regional center starts your child's intake. Having the right words and information ready makes the call shorter and less stressful. To find your regional center, search “find my regional center” on the California Department of Developmental Services website, dds.ca.gov.

- 1** **Have this ready**
Your child's full name and date of birth, your address and phone number, your health insurance information, and the diagnosis report if you have one.
- 2** **Say why you're calling**
“Hello, my name is _____. My child, _____, is _____ years old and was recently diagnosed with autism. I'd like to request an intake for regional center services.” If your child is under 3, add: “I'd like to ask about Early Start.”
- 3** **Ask about next steps**
“What happens next, and about how long does it take?” “What documents should I send?” “Who will be my contact person?”
- 4** **Ask for language support**
If you'd prefer another language, say so: “I'd like to communicate in Spanish (or Mandarin). Can you provide an interpreter or a Spanish-speaking (or Mandarin-speaking) staff member?”
- 5** **Write it down**
Before you hang up, repeat back the next steps. Write the date, the name of the person you spoke with and what they said in the notes below.
- 6** **Follow up**
If you haven't heard back by the date they gave you, call again and mention the date of your first call.

Call notes

Date _____

Person I spoke with _____

Next steps _____

Follow up by _____

Keep these notes in your family folder.